

Contents

Linguistic Tricks: A Semantic Inventory 1

1. Working concept 1

Instrumental untruthfulness as a communicative orientation 2

Distributed carrier front end 3

Where linguistic tricks sit in the epistemic architecture 3

Sophism and sophistry 5

2. Integrity dimensions 5

3. Inventory 6

A. Assertion and information selection 6

B. Meaning, implication, and framing 8

C. Diversion and corruption of discussion 15

D. Moral attribution and enemy construction 17

E. Agenda, representation, and policy coupling 21

4. Important boundaries 22

Honest error is not insincerity 22

Semantic disagreement is not necessarily manipulation 22

Framing and conceptual engineering are not inherently dishonest 22

A recognition cue is not automatically a counterfeit 22

Open-textured judgment is not automatically pseudo-measurement 22

An omitted mechanism is not automatically a lie 23

A fallacy is not automatically a lie 23

Effects are not always tricks 23

5. Relation to the epistemic constitution 23

Pragma-dialectics as prior work toward communicative truthfulness 24

6. Provenance and limitations 24

Linguistic Tricks: A Semantic Inventory

Status: Working, source-backed inventory

Scope: Linguistic mechanisms developed in project conversations and checked against public source bridges **Purpose:** A component of the reality-anchored, truth-seeking epistemic constitution described in 0010-culture-mechanics.semantic-definition.md and 0020-epistemic-agency.semantic-definition.md

Within *Culture Program Ecology*, these mechanisms can help Culture Programs conceal conflict, protect load-bearing claims from defeat, attack rivals, or simulate public correction. Their presence is diagnostic evidence, not by itself proof that a program is Pure-Ideology or that the speaker intended deception.

1. Working concept

The reviewed source material uses *linguistic tricks* as a practical name for sophisticated forms of lying and truth-obscuring speech. The term intentionally retains a strategic connotation, but the inventory separates the observable form and its situated operation from a further attribution of knowledge or intent.

The family resemblance is:

A linguistic trick subordinates one or more truth-supporting conditions of communication to operative effectiveness while preserving enough of the appearance or authority of communication to steer an audience.

The classification has three levels:

Level	Meaning	Attribution boundary
Linguistic-trick form	A communicative structure capable of misleading, diverting, immunizing, or steering reconstruction.	Intent and actual situated function remain open.

Level	Meaning	Attribution boundary
Operative linguistic trick	In context, the form actually subordinates one or more truth-supporting conditions to audience steering while retaining communicative appearance or authority.	The strategic connotation remains, but the present carrier's knowledge or design is not established.
Deliberate linguistic trick	The operation was knowingly or strategically selected for its misleading, diversionary, immunizing, or manipulative effect.	Requires actor-level evidence beyond the operation itself.

An originator may design a trick deliberately, a later carrier may repeat it sincerely, an institution may select it because it works without explicitly representing its mechanism, and incentives may reproduce it without one designer. A communicative form can also have an adverse effect without satisfying either the operative-trick classification or an intent attribution. Pattern, asymmetric application, strategic retreat, hidden dialogue purpose, resistance to correction, internal records, or admission can strengthen the intent inference.

This inventory uses *lie* in a broad normative sense. An utterance need not contain a literally false sentence to belong here. It can mislead by omission, implication, presupposition, redefinition, framing, diversion, attribution, contextual manipulation, or corruption of the dialogue itself. This does not make every use of rhetoric, framing, conceptual innovation, ambiguity, or a fallacious argument intentionally deceptive.

Instrumental untruthfulness as a communicative orientation

The analytical umbrella recovered during source development is **instrumental untruthfulness** (*instrumentelle Unwahrhaftigkeit*):

Instrumental untruthfulness is a communicative orientation in which a specified actor, role, programme, or institution selects, shapes, retains, suppresses, or distributes communication principally for operative effect, while subordinating truth, accuracy, sincerity, shared meaning, reciprocal examination, reasonable resolution, or correction.

It does not require a literally false sentence. Selective truths, omission, implication, framing, ambiguity, staged opposition, strategic silence, direct falsification, or combinations of them can serve the orientation. One trick does not automatically establish a stable orientation. One sufficiently clear act may be probative, but recurrent selection, retention after correction, and cross-situation consistency ordinarily provide stronger evidence.

Instrumental untruthfulness answers a **selection question**:

Why was this communication selected, shaped, retained, suppressed, or routed in this way?

Un-reason answers a different **correction question**:

What happens to reasoning when the protected conclusion is threatened?

The two relations are orthogonal:

	Truth-correctible reasoning	Un-reason
Sincere, non-instrumental communication	The speaker communicates sincerely and the account can lose.	A sincere believer does not select communication for operative effect, yet the believer's reasoning arranges every reply so that the protected account cannot lose.
Instrumental untruthfulness	A propagandist or strategist may privately understand the relevant reality while deliberately misleading an audience; the private model need not be un-reasoned.	A person, programme, or institution both steers communication for effect and recursively protects its own account from correction.

The table must be applied to one specified unit and level at a time. For a person, distinguish outward communication selection from the person's own correction logic. For an institution or programme, compare its output-selection rules with its own correction rules. Do not infer private un-reason from strategic public communication or actor-level instrumental intent from institution-level selection. The row label deliberately says *sincere*, not *true*: sincerity and reality-tracking remain distinct.

Actor-level attribution requires evidence that the actor privileged communicative effect over the relevant truth-supporting conditions. Private–public divergence, internal instructions, acknowledged corrections, audience segmentation, strategic retreat and later re-entry, continued use after exposure, or explicit concern with optics and narrative over accuracy can support that inference. Disagreement or adverse effect alone cannot.

At institutional or programme level, the object changes:

Institutionalized instrumental untruthfulness exists when selection, reward, routing, memory, and correction patterns reliably preserve effect-producing communication over more accurate or more corrigible alternatives.

This does not imply that every carrier understands or intends the selection relation. The attribution must identify the programme, institution, domain, and period and provide evidence for the operative pattern.

Distributed carrier front end

Communicative production, transmission, and uptake must be separated before any inference to un-reason or a systemic condition:

ORIGINATOR OR SELECTOR

creates, selects, retains, suppresses, or routes a communicative form

|
v

CARRIER

repeats, translates, condenses, amplifies, or performs it
strategically, habitually, role-obediently, or sincerely

|
v

RECIPIENT RECONSTRUCTION

the recipient reconstructs a factual, causal, moral,
identity, or authorization model rather than merely copying words

The originator's or selector's mental state does not transfer to the carrier, and the carrier's utterance does not determine what the recipient reconstructs. One participant may knowingly design a misleading operation; another may repeat it sincerely; a third may understand it differently or reject it. Translation, condensation, sloganization, contextual change, trusted-source gain, and the recipient's installed Culture Program can preserve, intensify, weaken, or alter the operative form at each transition.

Analysis should therefore identify separately:

1. the provenance and selection rule of the communicative form;
2. the carrier's access, fidelity, incentives, role, and own evidential state;
3. the recipient's actual reconstruction and any change in judgment or conduct;
4. the evidence, if any, for deliberate selection at each position.

The inventory owns this communicative front end. *Epistemic Constitution owns the complete distributed carrier sequence*, including the possible transitions from recipient reconstruction through un-reason, un-reality, organized un-reality, and systemic lying. None of those later stages follows from transmission or sincere belief alone, and each arrow requires separate evidence.

Where linguistic tricks sit in the epistemic architecture

The inventory begins at the observable communicative surface, but its entries must not be inflated into conclusions about reasoning, social reality, or an entire constitution. The canonical *typed epistemic architecture* keeps six different kinds of object distinct:

Term	Type	Relation to this inventory
Linguistic trick Instrumental untruthfulness	Communicative operation Communicative selection orientation	The inventory's primary object. Explains why an actor, role, programme, or institution selects or preserves communication for operative effect over truth-supporting conditions.
Un-reason	Inferential and correction-defeating mechanism	May use several tricks, but is not another inventory entry.
Un-real representation	Operative state or output	May receive wording through tricks, but requires practical reality-status insulated from independent correction.
Organized un-reality	Installed multi-channel stock	Requires fitted human, linguistic, symbolic, incentive, record, and institutional channels.
Systemic-lying epistemic constitution	Constitutional meta-order	Recurrently generates, selects, authorizes, protects, and replaces organized un-reality.

The [theoretical *un-* family](#) supplies the broader internal-deformation construction behind *un-reason* and *un-reality*. Its [constitutive-relation-inversion morphology](#) specifies their direct reversal of epistemic answerability. [Pseudomorphic governor substitution](#) is the separate, thicker bearer-level morphology and is not established by a linguistic trick, un-reason, or un-reality alone. This does not make every *un-* word an instance of the restricted theoretical family.

The possible sequence is conditional rather than a mandatory ladder:

```

originator or selector
  may select a trick through instrumental untruthfulness
    |
    v
carrier
  may repeat it strategically, habitually, role-obediently, or sincerely
    |
    v
recipient
  reconstructs a factual, causal, moral, identity, or authorization model
    |
    v
un-reason may protect that model when correction threatens it
    |
    v
un-reality arises only if the model receives or retains operative authority
despite failed correction
    |
    v
organized un-reality requires installation across coordinated channels
    |
    v
systemic lying requires recurrent constitutional generation, selection,
authorization, reproduction, protection, and replacement

```

No row or arrow proves the next. Different people, roles, and institutions can perform selection, transmission, reconstruction, defensive reasoning, record custody, sanction, and reproduction. Intent, knowledge, guilt, and coordination do not travel with the message. The [complete distributed carrier sequence](#) therefore requires evidence for every transition.

Two further boundaries prevent common category errors:

- **Systematic lying** is methodical deceptive conduct attributed to a specified actor or organization. **Systemic lying** is a constitutional truth orientation that strategic actors, sincere believers, conformists, officials, roles, incentives, and institutions can reproduce together. Neither is necessary or sufficient for the other. The stock-flow relation through which a systemic-lying meta-order produces organized un-reality is developed in [Culture Program Ecology, Appendix A.1](#).
- Correction can be blocked at two different interfaces. **Un-reason** can neutralize what a correction is allowed to mean; **correction nullification** can prevent an understood correction from changing authority, records, operation, or repair. Neither follows from one trick or one unanswered claim.

Likewise, an alternative causal account is not suspect merely because it explains an apparent disconfirmation. Ordinary Bayesian explaining-away remains legitimate when the alternative is independently supported, inspectable, predictively exposed, reciprocally tested, and permitted to lose. The **auxiliary-un-reality explaining-away cascade** becomes counterfeit when an authorized auxiliary account protects the incumbent representation while those correction conditions are disabled. Linguistic tricks can help formulate or protect that account, but they do not establish the wider cascade by themselves.

Sophism and sophistry

Sophism is an important established name for a large subset of what this inventory calls linguistic tricks. A sophism is an argument that appears rational or valid but owes its persuasive force to a concealed ambiguity, invalid inference, misrepresentation, irrelevant consideration, or comparable defect that obstructs truth-seeking. **Sophistry** is the practice or style of constructing and deploying such arguments.

The terms are related but not interchangeable:

- A **fallacy** is a defect in reasoning and can be committed accidentally.
- A **sophism** is an apparently plausible, argument-shaped maneuver whose defect is concealed or exploited; the term ordinarily carries a stronger implication of strategic or intellectually dishonest use.
- **Sophistry** is the systematic practice of producing, combining, or habitually relying on sophisms.
- A **linguistic trick** is broader. It also includes non-argumentative operations such as omission, euphemistic inversion, defamatory labeling, dog-whistle messaging, information flooding, and source manipulation.
- **Instrumental untruthfulness** is broader still: it is the governing orientation that subordinates truth-supporting conditions to operative effect and can employ sophistry alongside many other mechanisms.

The conceptual nesting is therefore:

```
instrumental untruthfulness
├── direct and informational deception
├── semantic and rhetorical manipulation
├── sophistry
│   └── sophisms
├── dialogue manipulation
└── propaganda and systemic deployment
```

Sophisms should consequently not be added below as one more mechanism beside equivocation, presupposition smuggling, straw men, burden reversal, or motte-and-bailey shifts. They are a **cross-cutting, argument-shaped class** instantiated by many of those mechanisms. A mechanism becomes sophistical when it is incorporated into an apparently reasoned case whose concealed defect supplies its persuasive advantage.

2. Integrity dimensions

The inventory normalizes the mechanisms against nine project-developed integrity dimensions.

Code	Integrity dimension	Governing question
TI	Truth integrity	Are asserted propositions presented in accordance with the speaker's evidence and beliefs?
II	Information integrity	Is relevant information included rather than selectively withheld or flooded out?

Code	Integrity dimension	Governing question
RI	Relevance integrity	Does the response address the actual issue and evidence?
CI	Clarity integrity	Is the communication sufficiently clear to permit scrutiny?
SI	Sincerity integrity	Does public speech truthfully express what the speaker thinks?
MI	Meaning integrity	Are words used in shared, stable, and inspectable senses?
DI	Discussion integrity	Are the standpoint, burdens, reasons, and closure rules handled fairly?
LI	Dialogue integrity	Is the overt kind of conversation also the operative kind of conversation?
XI	Context/source integrity	Are origin, context, identity, and evidential status represented honestly?

These dimensions are diagnostic, not mutually exclusive boxes. One mechanism commonly violates several at once.

3. Inventory

A. Assertion and information selection

LT-001 — Direct falsification

- **Aliases:** lie by commission; false assertion.
- **Operation:** Assert as true a proposition the speaker believes to be false or inadequately supported.
- **Integrity:** TI, SI.
- **Status:** Established core category.

LT-002 — Omission and selective concealment

- **Aliases:** lie by omission; suppression; selective disclosure.
- **Operation:** Present a technically compatible fragment while withholding information needed to form the materially correct picture.
- **Integrity:** II, TI, SI.
- **Status:** Established core category.

LT-003 — Paltering and false implicature

- **Aliases:** misleading truth; deceptive implicature.
- **Operation:** Use literally true statements to induce a conclusion the speaker regards as false, retaining the escape that the false conclusion was never explicitly stated.
- **Integrity:** TI, II, SI.
- **Diagnostic:** Ask what a reasonable listener was meant to infer, not only what the sentence literally entailed.

LT-004 — Bullshit and evidential indifference

- **Aliases:** assertion without truth orientation; argumentative bullshit.
- **Operation:** Speak for impression, status, mobilization, or persuasion without treating the truth or falsity of the content as a governing constraint.
- **Integrity:** TI, SI.
- **Status:** Established category; distinct from a lie narrowly defined because knowledge of the truth need not guide the speaker.

LT-005 — Trade-off suppression

- **Aliases:** one-sided effect selection; effect/side-effect asymmetry.
- **Operation:** Describe only the desired effect or only the unwanted side effect of a measure, thereby concealing that action and inaction both involve benefits, costs, risks, and alternatives.
- **Integrity:** II, RI.
- **Status:** Project-developed term; the exact formulation was not located in the reviewed source material during this pass.
- **Diagnostic:** Require the same ledger—benefits, harms, uncertainty, alternatives, and opportunity costs—for favored and disfavored measures.

LT-006 — Information flooding

- **Aliases:** firehose of falsehood; attention saturation; epistemic overload.
- **Operation:** Produce claims at a volume and speed that exceeds the audience's capacity to test them, allowing important disagreements to drown in low-cost messages.
- **Integrity:** II, RI, TI.
- **Status:** Established propaganda family; also a bridge from individual speech acts to systemic lying.

LT-047 — Wall-of-text obfuscation

- **Aliases:** discursive burial; qualification flooding; context flooding; originating German formulation *Textschwall als Verschleierung*.
- **Operation:** Surround a principal claim, finding, correction, or consequence with a disproportionate volume of context, caveats, remote possibilities, repetitions, procedural detail, and superficially balancing considerations until the reader can no longer recover the hierarchy of importance. The text may contain many individually true, relevant, or defensible sentences while its organization conceals what the evidence principally establishes.
- **Integrity:** II, RI, CI, DI.
- **Characteristic sequence:**
 - clear central finding
 - every possible qualification and side issue receives foreground space
 - decisive and remote considerations appear co-equal
 - attention and working memory are consumed
 - the reader retains complexity, uncertainty, or fatigue rather than the evidence-weighted result
- **Diagnostic:** State the text's principal finding, decisive evidence, necessary qualifications, and bounded conclusion in a short hierarchy. Then ask whether the original makes that hierarchy easier or harder to see; whether rival explanations receive space proportionate to their evidence and materiality; whether a qualification changes the conclusion or merely proves that another possibility can be imagined; and whether secondary detail could be routed later without loss of evidential discipline.
- **Boundary:** Length, completeness, multiple rivals, technical detail, or extensive qualification do not by themselves instantiate the operation. A long analysis may be necessary for reconstruction and accountability. The warning applies when volume and placement predictably bury the principal result or falsely flatten the evidential hierarchy. Compression becomes a different defect when it removes material evidence, serious rivals, uncertainty, non-inferences, or defeaters.
- **Relation to LT-006:** Information flooding primarily overloads verification through the number and speed of messages or claims. Wall-of-text obfuscation primarily overloads orientation within a text by denying the reader a usable hierarchy of decisional relevance. One deployment can contain both.
- **Attribution boundary:** Diagnose the communicative form before inferring design. Weak editing, defensive completeness, specialist habit, unresolved thought, or fear of criticism can produce the same surface form. Deliberate concealment requires separate evidence.
- **Status:** Project-developed normalization from the originating author's *Textschwall als Verschleierung* criticism and the present reader-edition workflow.

B. Meaning, implication, and framing

LT-007 — Equivocation and private-definition escape

- **Aliases:** semantic ambiguity; mental reservation; strategic polysemy.
- **Operation:** Exploit a word's different senses—or silently use a specialist/private sense—so the audience receives one meaning while the speaker later retreats to another.
- **Integrity:** MI, CI, SI.

LT-008 — Persuasive redefinition

- **Aliases:** persuasive definition; semantic extension or contraction; illegitimate extension of vocabulary; definitional drift.
- **Operation:** Preserve a word's favorable or condemnatory emotional force while changing the cases to which it applies. The inherited evaluation is transferred without having to justify it anew.
- **Integrity:** MI, DI.
- **Examples of form:** "True freedom is obedience"; expanding a grave term so that minor or disputed cases inherit its moral force.
- **External source bridge:** In *totgedacht* (2002), "Marsch durch die Definitionen," pp. 127–128, Roland Baader describes the semantic hollowing of terms followed by their "occupation" through reinterpretation. The immediately preceding section, "Verrat der Intellektuellen," pp. 124–126, explicitly treats Benda's *La trahison des clercs* and connects moral immunization against facts and politically amplified intellectual authority to the later semantic method; *Epistemic Constitution*, "Benda's truth-utility bridge" preserves the distinct vocation-level source relation. His formulation supplies a source-attested neighbour for persuasive redefinition and possible core displacement; it does not by itself establish manipulation, intent, un-reason, un-reality, Babelization, or institutional uptake in any named case.

LT-009 — Doublespeak and euphemistic inversion

- **Aliases:** semantic cosmetics; inverted meaning; bureaucratic euphemism.
- **Operation:** Rename an act so that its description obscures agency, cost, coercion, or moral character—or makes an adverse reality sound benign.
- **Integrity:** MI, CI, SI.

LT-042 — Newspeak-style vocabulary restriction

- **Source term:** **Newspeak**, from *George Orwell's Nineteen Eighty-Four*.
- **Operation:** Deliberately reduce, prohibit, or institutionally displace words and distinctions needed to formulate, compare, or publicly circulate disfavoured propositions, thereby raising the cognitive and social cost of making the rival account explicit.
- **Integrity:** MI, CI, DI.
- **Boundary:** Newspeak is not an alias for doublespeak. Doublespeak obscures an act through a misleading expression; Newspeak-style restriction narrows the available expressive repertoire. Vocabulary always changes, terminological economy can clarify, and losing one word does not make a thought literally impossible. Diagnosis requires evidence of directional restriction, institutionally enforced replacement, or the systematic removal of distinctions needed for criticism.
- **Status:** Orwell's literary device is the source model; this entry extracts a bounded linguistic operation and does not claim strong linguistic determinism or empirical validation of the fictional system.

LT-010 — Presupposition smuggling

- **Aliases:** presupposition manipulation; loaded question; assumption smuggling.
- **Operation:** Encode a disputed proposition as already given rather than assert it openly, so accepting the grammatical frame silently concedes the point.
- **Integrity:** TI, MI, DI.
- **Diagnostic:** Extract every proposition that must already be true for the question or sentence to work.

LT-011 — Selective framing

- **Aliases:** frame control; aspect selection; interpretive steering.

- **Operation:** Select and emphasize aspects of reality so as to privilege a problem definition, causal account, moral evaluation, or remedy while rendering competing descriptions less visible.
- **Integrity:** II, RI; sometimes MI.
- **Boundary:** Framing is unavoidable; the trick lies in concealing consequential selections, excluding rival frames, or presenting a contestable frame as reality itself.

LT-048 — Guided problem representation

- **Aliases:** problem-model steering; calculation-frame substitution; induced substitute-problem reasoning.
- **Operation:** Arrange wording, sequence, quantities, comparison bases, causal boundaries, or prompts so that the anticipated recipient constructs a substitute problem and then applies a locally valid calculation or inference to it, mistaking the self-produced result for an answer to the materially relevant problem.
- **Distinctive feature:** The decisive defect is installed upstream of the recipient's reasoning. The arithmetic or inference inside the substitute model may be correct; the persuasive force comes partly from the recipient experiencing the conclusion as independently derived rather than merely asserted.
- **Characteristic sequence:**

materially relevant problem P
 → wording and selection cue a narrower or distorted problem P'
 → the recipient reconstructs P'
 → a locally valid operation produces result R'
 → R' is accepted as the answer to P
- **Integrity:** II, RI, CI; sometimes TI and MI.
- **Diagnostic:** State the materially relevant question and its system boundary; reconstruct the problem the wording most readily induces; identify which quantities, relations, baselines, time horizons, or causal stages disappeared; solve both representations; and ask whether the presentation disclosed that its result answered only the narrower question.
- **Examples of form:** A rate question foregrounds aggregate quantities so that the reader scales time although production occurs in parallel; a system-impact comparison foregrounds the efficiency of an end device so that the reader treats a component-level calculation as an end-to-end result.
- **Boundary and counterexamples:** Every finite problem statement selects a model, and a simplified model can be legitimate when its assumptions and scope are explicit and adequate to the question. A recreational trick question that announces the puzzle and promptly reveals the trap uses the form pedagogically rather than subordinating truth-supporting communication to covert steering. Ambiguous wording, recipient haste, mathematical error, or an honestly mistaken model does not by itself establish an operative or deliberate linguistic trick.
- **Relations:** LT-011 covers consequential aspect selection generally; LT-048 is the narrower operation in which the selected frame recruits the recipient's own reasoning to answer a substitute problem. LT-018 redirects an already disputed proposition or discussion, whereas LT-048 can install the substitute before the relevant question has been made explicit. LT-002 may supply the omissions, LT-010 a smuggled premise, and LT-003 the false implication, but none of them alone identifies the valid-operation-on-wrong-model sequence.
- **Recipient-model relation:** *Epistemic Agency under Mechanical Solidarity*, “Audience-modelled reconstruction and decompression” owns the general reconstruction mechanism. Evidence that the induced representation was predictable, recurrently selected, asymmetrically preserved, or retained after correction strengthens the move from form to operative or deliberate trick.
- **Status and open question:** Project-developed normalization from the originating author's comparison between short calculation traps and a component-versus-system environmental argument. Its distinctness is conceptual; comparative testing of intended and actual recipient reconstructions remains an empirical task.

LT-043 — Pseudo-metric predication

- **Aliases:** metric-form language without metric content; simulated assessment; verdictive pseudo-measurement.

- **Operation:** Attach comparative, threshold, or evaluative language to an object without supplying a stable operational rule capable of determining whether the predicate applies. The expression thereby makes an unexposed judgment sound like the result of measurement or an independently applied classification.
- **Canonical compression:** There may be no hidden ruler. The language merely imitates the authority of having used a ruler.
- **Characteristic forms:** *significant biodiversity value, adequate ecological integrity, unacceptable biodiversity loss*, or parallel phrases in which *significant, adequate, unacceptable, meaningful, balanced*, or *representative* appears to report a crossed threshold without identifying the threshold or rule.
- **Operation sequence:**
 - underspecified object
 - + measurement-like or threshold predicate
 - + institutional or expert authority
 - apparent factual assessment
 - unexposed evaluative verdict
 - presupposed deficit
 - permission to intervene
- **Integrity:** MI, II, CI, DI; sometimes LI.
- **Diagnostic:** Ask the speaker to decompress the predicate into its object, dimension, baseline, comparison class, spatial and temporal scale, threshold or qualitative decision rule, evidence rule, uncertainty treatment, conflict rule, and possible defeater or completion condition. Then test whether independent reviewers can understand the application, whether comparable cases receive comparable treatment, and whether counterevidence and appeal can change the verdict.
- **Relation to metric custody:** An explicit metric discloses its operational rule. A tacit criterion has a stable operational rule in professional convention, guidance, precedent, or practice but withholds it from public inspection. Pseudo-metric predication is the stricter third case: no stable ruler may exist. If implementation later reveals a stable internal rule, the case becomes tacit criterion custody. If officials decide case by case, it remains interpreter custody and authorization without specification, which can feed discretionary policy custody.
- **Relation to the model-to-mandate chain:** When an inspectable metric and real model do exist, this trick may not be present. The audit must instead test construct validity, decision-scale model adequacy, causal-harm translation, protected-principal valuation, severity threshold, remedy comparison, authorization, and outcome correction separately. The generic [model-to-mandate custody chain](#) prevents the prestige of a valid early stage from laundering unargued later crossings. Conversely, a disputed later crossing does not show that the measurement or model is false.
- **Related operations:** LT-040 supplies the recognition cues of assessment without the corresponding function; LT-010 can presuppose that a relevant threshold has been crossed; LT-008 can transfer the authority of a valued term; LT-011 can hide competing dimensions and trade-offs; LT-041 can conceal the implementing powers and sacrifices; and LT-045 applies when a real later model exists but its output is presented as observed confirmation that an earlier prediction came true. When observed or predicted *change* is called *deterioration*, the [Hanekamp–Wegner bridge](#) tests the intervening relevant-structure and moral-appraisal step; the word is not pseudo-metric merely because it is evaluative.
- **PCP routing:** At [Perception](#), the predicate reports that a condition has supposedly been identified; at Context, it classifies that condition as a relevant deficit; at Permission, it helps authorize the guardian, expert, or institution to impose the apparently required remedy. The route is a diagnostic reconstruction, not proof that every use was designed in those stages.
- **Boundary:** Numbers are neither necessary nor sufficient. A nonnumerical, open-textured, or expert criterion is not pseudo-metric when its purpose, factors, boundaries, evidence, reasons, and revision or appeal route are sufficiently inspectable. Nor is every shorthand phrase manipulative. Classification strengthens when the expression itself is treated as sufficient evidence for binding action, resists decompression, substitutes asymmetrically for reasons, or remains insulated from correction.
- **General-mechanism relation:** [Mythology Construction](#), [“Metric custody in more detail”](#) owns the constructed-mapping and custody mechanism; this inventory owns the observable communicative operation.

- **Status:** Project-developed compound operation extracted from the Humanism–Diversity, metric-custody, and silent-principal analysis. It names the communicative operation, not a finding about any phrase, field, speaker, or institution merely because measurement language is used.

LT-045 — Model-to-reality laundering

- **Aliases:** forecast-as-outcome substitution; prediction-validation laundering; prediction-as-measurement substitution.
- **Operation:** Give the output of a later model the evidential status of an observed fulfilment of an earlier model's prediction. Words such as *confirmed*, *validated*, *vindicated*, or *borne out* then move the audience from agreement among calculations to the belief that the predicted event or outcome was measured in reality.
- **Elementary rule: Models make predictions. Reality tests them. A later prediction must not be presented as the observed fulfilment of an earlier one.**
- **Operation sequence:**
 - earlier model predicts outcome X
 - reality should eventually test whether X occurred
 - later model also calculates X
 - agreement is described as confirmation or validation
 - model agreement acquires the status of observed reality
 - the earlier prediction escapes its outcome test
- **Integrity:** TI, II, MI, DI, XI.
- **Diagnostic:** Recover the original prediction's population or case, outcome, interval, uncertainty range, and stated causal route. Then identify what the later source actually supplies: an observation of that outcome, a re-estimation, an updated forecast, a scenario, a back-test, or another model using partly shared assumptions. State separately what was measured, what was calculated, what assumptions were carried forward, and which evidential status the public wording assigns to each.
- **Boundary:** A later model may legitimately strengthen or weaken confidence in an earlier prediction, especially when it uses independent data or methods. Agreement among models can be evidence of robustness, but it is not by itself evidence that the predicted outcome occurred. A nowcast, data-assimilation system, or model-based estimate can incorporate observations; classify its measured and model-derived components precisely rather than treating the whole output as either direct observation or mere speculation. Loose wording or an honest category mistake establishes neither an operative trick nor deliberate deception.
- **Relations:** LT-007 can shift *confirmation* between model agreement and empirical fulfilment; LT-040 can supply the cues of scientific validation without its outcome-testing function; LT-037 covers false representation of evidential standing; and LT-043 covers measurement-like verdicts for which no stable ruler may exist. LT-045 is the narrower case in which a real later model exists but its output is laundered across the model–reality boundary.
- **Report-to-reality relation:** This operation is a model-specific sibling of [report-to-reality laundering](#). The latter turns outputs of a reporting apparatus into independently established reality without testing the intervening transformations; LT-045 turns a calculated output into observed fulfilment without testing the predicted outcome.
- **Un-reality relation:** LT-045 can supply a linguistic front end for un-reality, but a phrase or single substitution does not establish un-reason, operative un-reality, systemic lying, or design. The stronger classification requires evidence that the model-derived representation acquires practical authority and remains protected when outcome evidence should correct it. Recurrent institutional selection after the distinction has been made explicit can support an inference of operative instrumental untruthfulness or correction resistance; deliberate design still requires separate actor-level evidence.
- **General-mechanism relation:** [Epistemic Constitution](#), [“Model-mediated mandates and prediction exposure”](#) owns the model-versus-measurement rule and the full correction audit. This inventory owns the observable communicative substitution.
- **Status:** Project-developed communicative operation extracted from the model-versus-measurement revision. It does not classify any model, prediction, publication, speaker, or institution without separate case evidence.

LT-012 — Outcome relabeling

- **Aliases:** terminus relabeling; “true X” maneuver; procedural-value substitution.
- **Operation:** Stretch a procedural or contestable value into an absolute, declare existing practices counterfeit, then reserve the value’s name for the speaker’s preferred outcome—for example, defining democracy as the policy that “the people truly want.”
- **Integrity:** MI, DI, LI.

LT-013 — Benevolent-language camouflage

- **Aliases:** care-speak; safety camouflage; coercion-as-care; convenience rhetoric.
- **Operation:** Describe expanding control, penalties, dependence, observation, reporting, or loss of exit in the language of care, concern, safety, support, vigilance, responsibility, and convenience, thereby borrowing benevolent intent as a shield against structural examination. The language can also recruit a morally creditable actor-role: reporting becomes proof of civic concern, while restraint or procedural criticism risks appearing indifferent to the protected person or good.
- **Integrity:** MI, II, LI.
- **Diagnostic:** Compare the favourable action-name and actor identity with the installed function, custody, burdens, sanctions, contestability, reversibility, exit, and consequences. Keep *reporting*, *alleging*, *verifying*, and *adjudicating* distinct; ask whether moral credit from the end or reporter role has spilled into epistemic credit for the resulting record.
- **Boundary:** Benevolent language is not evidence of concealed coercion, false reporting, or bad faith. Care, safety, and confidential reporting can name real goods. The diagnostic is whether the wording prevents the operation from being classified and corrected by what it actually does.
- **Ecology relation:** The [moralized observation-to-mandate loop](#) owns the complete role grammar; this entry owns only the local communicative camouflage and recruitment operation.

LT-014 — Dog-whistle double address

- **Aliases:** coded appeal; dual-audience messaging.
- **Operation:** Use an expression with an innocuous public reading and a second, group-coded reading, enabling mobilization of insiders alongside deniability to outsiders.
- **Integrity:** MI, SI.

LT-015 — Diffamatory fighting term

- **Original term:** *diffamierender Kampfbegriff*.
- **Operation:** Attach a negatively charged label to a person, group, or idea so moral rejection occurs before factual examination; justification is replaced by moral marking.
- **Integrity:** RI, MI, DI.
- **Status:** User-selected compound term.

LT-016 — Symbol displacement

- **Original term:** *Symbolverschiebung*.
- **Operation:** Turn a neutral or minor object into the emotionally charged proxy for a diffuse conflict; shared rejection of the proxy synchronizes a group and substitutes symbolic hostility for examination of the underlying issue.
- **Integrity:** RI, II; sometimes MI.
- **Boundary:** This can emerge collectively without a designing speaker; it is therefore also a culture mechanism, not only a deliberate trick.

LT-044 — Deconstructive reversal

- **Originating compression:** “Push the center to the periphery and the periphery into the center.”
- **Operation:** Expose and morally redescribe a center–periphery hierarchy, downgrade the incumbent center as derivative, oppressive, exclusionary, or obstructive, grant the formerly peripheral term privileged standing, and reinterpret the former center through the new center.
- **Generic sequence:**

- identify incumbent center
- identify excluded or subordinated periphery
- explain the center as dependent upon suppression of the periphery
- morally reverse the hierarchy
- make the former periphery the privileged standpoint or sacred principal
- reinterpret the former center through the new center

- **Integrity:** MI, II, DI; sometimes RI or LI.
- **Diagnostic:** Identify the original opposition, the evidence for actual subordination, the rule that transfers standing, which functions or goods of the old center survive, whether the former margin has become a new self-exempting center, and which affected persons gain or lose standing, jurisdiction, refusal, or appeal. Distinguish correction of a false hierarchy from installation of an inverted hierarchy.
- **Relation to mythology replacement:** The operation can help unbraid an incumbent mythology by withdrawing sacred or explanatory priority from its center and making its formerly marginal term available for successor rebraiding. In the [Humanism–Diversity application](#), expansion from the universe of humans toward ecological, cultural, and identity difference does not itself perform the reversal. Reversal requires the further displacement in which the former human center loses governing standing and the selected peripheral pattern acquires it.
- **Boundary:** This is the project’s selected name for a bounded operation, not a summary definition of Derrida or deconstruction as a whole. A fuller deconstructive double movement can also destabilize the reversed opposition rather than installing the former margin as a new center. The entry establishes no Derridean genealogy, conscious plan, manipulative intent, or moral valence. A reversal can expose a real exclusion, correct unjustified privilege, broaden standing, produce a mixed or supplementary order, install a new domination, or fail.
- **Related operations:** LT-011 can hide the selection of center and margin; LT-008 can transfer inherited moral force to the successor term; LT-013 can supply a benevolent wrapper; LT-040 can substitute recognition cues for function; and LT-041 can omit the successor’s operational mechanism, jurisdiction, and burdens. None is entailed by reversal.
- **Status:** User-selected project expression developed from a remembered popular compression of deconstruction. The normalized definition, sequence, diagnostic, Humanism–Diversity application, and boundaries are Culture Mechanics developments. The remembered formulation is a source lead, not a verified quotation from Derrida.

Staged mechanism — Semantic ballooning and core displacement

- **Operation:** Expand a morally or legally charged category far beyond its inherited prototype before relocating its practical center, so new or lesser cases inherit emotional force, institutional attention, or sanctions built for the old severe case.
- **Sequence:**
 - inherited prototype with strong favourable or condemnatory force
 - semantic ballooning into previously unoccupied cases
 - inherited-force transfer to the enlarged category
 - threshold flattening across unlike severities
 - prototype migration toward the newly emphasized cases
 - core displacement or practical essence replacement
- **Temporal variants:** Expansion can precede institutional uptake, or a severe sanction can first be authorized while the category remains narrowly anchored in an undisputed grave prototype. If the category later balloons and sanction-bearing institutions adopt the enlarged meaning, the new cases can inherit coercive capacity whose original authorization depended on the old center. This sanction-first sequence is a chronology to audit, not evidence that every severe penalty was enacted in anticipation of later redefinition.
- **Diagnostic:** Reconstruct the category at successive dates; identify its inherited prototype, constitutive mechanism, severity threshold, typical example, evidence standard, remedy, and sanction. Then ask which new cases entered, whether internal distinctions survived, which example now anchors public understanding, and whether sanction-bearing institutions adopted the enlarged meaning. Compare competence, attention, protection, and enforcement at the inherited center with vigilance and sanction at the expanding perimeter. Strong perimeter

vigilance alongside weak recognition or protection of the severe center is a priority and category-custody warning, not by itself proof of semantic replacement, selective enforcement, or anarcho-tyranny.

- **Legal-uptake boundary:** Semantic movement alone does not transfer legal punishment. Legislation, adjudication, administration, employment, licensing, professional discipline, or another institution must attach a burden to the changed category. [Anarcho-tyranny](#) owns that institutional-uptake and selective-activation question.
- **Sparse worked application:** The [Fernandes–HateAid–Hubig–ARD episode](#) tests whether “virtual rape” and “digital violence” transferred the force of severe embodied prototypes into a broader representational category and a prepared legal programme. It preserves the separate legal-uptake gate and does not infer equivalence, replacement, or selective activation from rhetoric alone.
- **Legitimate-development boundary:** A concept can properly broaden when the new cases share the relevant mechanism and the vocabulary preserves distinctions of degree, evidence, culpability, remedy, and sanction. Expansion is not core displacement merely because an old term gains an unfamiliar application.
- **Relations:** LT-008 supplies inherited-force transfer; LT-044 can move a new case from periphery to center; LT-013 can moralize the enlarged category; and LT-041 can conceal the changed threshold, enforcement machinery, and discarded prototype. The staged mechanism is not reducible to any one of them.
- **Integrity:** MI, II, DI; sometimes RI or LI.
- **Status:** Project-developed compound mechanism reconstructed from the originating discussion’s “balloon before replacement” sequence. The sanction-first variant and inherited-center/expanding-perimeter comparator are further project developments from the same discussion. The mechanism does not claim that every contested use of *abuse*, *violence*, *genocide*, *safety*, *freedom*, or another high-force word performs the operation.

Staged mechanism — Projective consensus and custodial completion

- **Operation:** A positively charged signifier loses enough particular content to let heterogeneous participants project different compatible goods into it; their overlapping assent appears to form a substantive consensus; an authorized custodian later supplies the executable meaning, thresholds, remedies, and exceptions.
- **Sequence:**

particular term yields much of its determinate content
→ heterogeneous participants project desired goods into it
→ shared token produces apparent coalition agreement
→ custodian translates the token into classifications and action
→ discretion migrates from participants to interpreter
- **Source boundary:** Ernesto Laclau’s [“Why Do Empty Signifiers Matter to Politics?”](#) supplies the precursor account in which a particular signifier can represent a larger heterogeneous whole or absent fullness. **Projective consensus** and **custodial completion** are the project’s operational additions.
- **Diagnostic:** Ask what each coalition member believed the token committed them to, what remained unspecified, who acquired authority to complete it, which operational meaning was selected, whether reasonable participants could foresee it, and whether they retain refusal, appeal, and revision after completion.
- **Boundaries:** Empty does not mean meaningless, fraudulent, or merely vague. Political and constitutional language must compress heterogeneous purposes. The hazard arises when projected agreement is counted as authorization for an implementation that participants did not jointly specify and cannot later correct. The mechanism establishes neither conscious deception nor one hidden ruler.
- **Relations:** LT-007 exploits incompatible meanings during exchange; LT-008 actively redefines; semantic ballooning enlarges category extension; projective consensus instead builds coalition breadth through under-determinate positive meaning. A master signifier can carry the token, and later institutional use can contribute to objective substitution or pseudomorphic governor substitution, but neither follows from the communicative stage alone.
- **Primary semantic home:** [Mythology Construction](#), [“Projective consensus, custodial operationalization, and governing-centre displacement”](#).

C. Diversion and corruption of discussion

LT-017 — Quibbling and irrelevant precision

- **Aliases:** hairsplitting; trivial objection; pedantic derailment.
- **Operation:** Focus scrutiny on a minor ambiguity, exception, or wording defect that does not materially affect the disputed claim, creating the appearance of refutation while avoiding its substance.
- **Integrity:** RI, DI.

LT-018 — Redirection

- **Aliases:** red herring; whataboutism; topic diversion; evasion.
- **Operation:** Replace the proposition under examination with another subject, comparison, accusation, or question that is easier or more advantageous to discuss.
- **Integrity:** RI, DI.
- **Diagnostic:** Restate the original proposition and ask whether the response changes its evidential status.

LT-019 — Psychologizing Bulverism

- **Original term:** *psychologisierender Bulverismus*.
- **Operation:** Evade examination of a thesis by presupposing it false and explaining instead which motive, pathology, identity, or defect allegedly caused the speaker to believe it.
- **Integrity:** RI, DI, TI.
- **Related but distinct:** ad hominem, genetic fallacy, motive fallacy, presupposition smuggling.

LT-046 — Civility shield

- **Aliases:** tone-to-credibility inversion; civility-as-truth cue; rhetorical style tax; tone-policing redirection.
- **Operation:** Give calm, polished, professional, or institutional language an evidentiary or exculpatory bonus while treating anger, satire, cynicism, colloquial language, or polemic as evidence against the speaker's proposition. Attention thereby moves from the alleged conduct and supporting evidence to the messenger's manner, and the effects of a long correction struggle can be used to discredit the person carrying the correction.
- **Operation sequence:**
power communicates through polished institutional form
→ a materially burdened corrector speaks sharply or polemically
→ style is treated as evidence of credibility or character
→ the corrector rather than the proposition becomes the object of scrutiny
→ the underlying claim escapes examination
- **Integrity:** RI, DI, II, XI.
- **Diagnostic:** Restate the proposition without its rhetorical vehicle; separate factual claim, evidence, uncertainty, mechanism hypothesis, moral judgment, and style; then ask whether the response changes the proposition's evidential status or merely changes the audience's attitude toward its carrier. Apply the same test when polished institutional language creates an unearned presumption of competence, independence, truth, or benevolence.
- **Boundary:** Tone can matter. Threats, targeted abuse, defamation, factual imprecision, obscurity, and rhetorical exaggeration can require criticism or reduce the reliability of a particular assertion. Nor does outsider status, personal cost, anger, or polemic prove sincerity or truth. LT-046 applies when style substitutes for claim-level examination or receives evidentiary force it does not possess, not whenever manner affects clarity, safety, or dialogue.
- **Relations:** LT-018 redirects from proposition to style; LT-019 explains the speaker instead of testing the thesis; LT-039 converts a signal into a character accusation; and LT-040 can let the cues of institutional professionalism substitute for truth-supporting function. The civility shield is the asymmetric style-and-source-position configuration joining those operations.
- **Epistemic-constitution relation:** *Epistemic Constitution*, "*Epistemic stewardship and responsible amplification*" owns source-form neutrality, responsible claim decomposition, and the boundary against treating costly dissent as truth. This inventory owns the observable communicative substitution.

- **Un-reality relation:** The shield can impair correction by preventing an evidenced proposition from receiving consideration, but its presence alone establishes neither un-reason, operative un-reality, systemic lying, nor actor design. Those stronger classifications retain their separate gates.
- **Status:** Project-developed operation extracted from the Loki-prior discussion and normalized beyond its originating case. It classifies no source, speaker, institution, or controversy merely because one side speaks more sharply than another.

LT-020 — Standpoint substitution

- **Aliases:** straw man; misrepresentation; attributed-position drift.
- **Operation:** Replace an opponent's actual position with a weaker, more extreme, or more morally objectionable one and refute the substitute.
- **Integrity:** DI, TI, RI.

LT-021 — Caricature-demonic phantom-enemy distortion

- **Original term:** *karikaturdämonisches Phantomfeind-Zerrbild als Hassfigur*.
- **Operation:** Construct a grossly exaggerated, morally demonized opponent from selected and invented attributes, then make this phantom a collective hate object. It is a socially elaborated straw man whose function includes affective mobilization and group identity.
- **Integrity:** TI, II, RI, DI.
- **Status:** User-developed compound term.

LT-022 — Burden reversal and immunization

- **Aliases:** burden shifting; unfalsifiable retreat; proof-demand asymmetry.
- **Operation:** Demand that critics disprove an unsupported claim, or continually alter what would count as counterevidence, insulating the favored position from the obligations imposed on alternatives.
- **Integrity:** DI, TI.

LT-023 — Closure sabotage

- **Aliases:** moving the goalposts; false declaration of victory; refusal to concede.
- **Operation:** Change success criteria after evidence arrives, refuse the consequences of a defeated claim, or declare resolution without answering the decisive objection.
- **Integrity:** DI, SI.

LT-024 — Covert dialogue-type switch

- **Original umbrella:** *Dialogintegritätsverletzung*.
- **Operation:** Ostensibly participate in inquiry or critical discussion while covertly operating by the rules of another dialogue—personal quarrel, negotiation, propaganda, interrogation, or audience performance.
- **Integrity:** LI, DI, SI.
- **Example:** A request to examine evidence becomes an occasion to diagnose the questioner or signal loyalty to spectators.

LT-025 — Reversive blockade

- **Original term:** *Reversive Blockade*.
- **Operation:** Assert an extreme opposite of the truth so emphatically that an audience disposed toward moderation searches for a midpoint and lands at a conclusion still displaced from reality in the manipulator's preferred direction.
- **Integrity:** TI, DI, MI.
- **Status:** Project-developed term; the exact phrase was not located in the reviewed source material during this pass.
- **Related mechanisms:** anchoring, false balance, midpoint fallacy, strategic polarization.

LT-026 — Person/group substitution by neologism

- **Prompting example:** *Zufallsmehrheiten*.
- **Operation:** Introduce a novel label that redirects attention from the substantive issue to the character or composition of persons and groups, allowing the original subject to remain unexamined.
- **Integrity:** RI, MI.
- **Status:** Provisional project reconstruction; the exact term was not located in the reviewed source material during this pass. More source context is needed before treating it as a settled independent type.

D. Moral attribution and enemy construction

Working heuristic — The iron law of ideological projection The **iron law of ideological projection** is the working heuristic that the less a closed ideological formation can acknowledge and correct its own discrediting motives, practices, and intentions, the more strongly it tends to attribute them to its opponents.

This is a proposed culture-mechanical principle, not an established scientific law. It generalizes the source-attested partisan expression “The Iron Law of Woke Projection” into a structurally neutral term. “Iron law” denotes a recurrent tendency, not an exceptionless rule.

It must not be converted into the claim that every accusation is a confession. That would itself become a sophism: the origin of an accusation would replace examination of its evidence. Every accusation must still be evaluated on its own evidence.

The heuristic contains several increasingly specific phenomena:

- **Psychological projection:** attributing one’s characteristics, affects, impulses, or responsibilities to another; it can be unconscious and nonstrategic.
- **Negative total projection:** transferring a generalized inventory of disowned badness to the enemy.
- **Accusation in a Mirror:** attributing one’s particular act or intention to the prospective victim.
- **Moral inversion:** more broadly reversing aggressor/defender, responsible party/victim, or good/evil roles.
- **DARVO:** the reactive sequence of denial, attack, and victim–offender reversal.

LT-027 — Accusation in a Mirror

- **Aliases:** AiM; mirror politics; mirror accusation; *Spiegelbeschuldigung*.
- **Functional description:** preventive blame reversal; *präventive Schuldumkehr*.
- **Operation:** Attribute one’s own intended or ongoing aggression to the opponent so that one’s aggression can be interpreted in advance as defensive necessity.
- **Integrity:** TI, II, RI.
- **Functions:** Preemptive attribution, moral disinhibition, information fog, reaction delay, pretext formation, and plausible deniability.
- **Specialized neighboring term:** *Human-rights inversion* is used for related inversions in international human-rights discourse.
- **Distinction:** AiM is narrower than psychological projection and moral inversion. It specifically mirrors the actor’s own conduct or intention and is commonly pre-emptive.

LT-028 — Positive moral appropriation

- **Aliases:** moral transfer; co-option; glittering generality; strategic mimicry.
- **Operation:** appropriate the respected symbols, achievements, virtues, or vocabulary of another tradition or group without accepting the practices that earned their positive standing.
- **Integrity:** XI, MI, SI.

LT-029 — Strategic moral reattribution

- **Original term:** *moralische Attributionsverschiebung*.
- **Operation:** Transfer one’s own negative characteristics to the opponent while transferring the opponent’s or a respected third party’s positive characteristics to oneself. The combined operation performs a rhetorical “moral balance-sheet cleanup.”
- **Negative subtype: Negative total projection** (*negative Totalprojektion*) attributes a broad inventory of the actor’s or in-group’s disowned vices to the enemy. Unlike strict AiM, it need not mirror one particular act or intention.

- **Positive subtype:** Positive moral appropriation transfers another party's virtues, achievements, symbols, or benevolent intentions to the in-group.
- **Integrity:** TI, XI, SI.
- **Status:** Synthetic family joining LT-027 and LT-028.

LT-030 — Comparison destruction and moral leveling

- **Original term:** *moralische Nivellierung*.
- **Aliases:** false equivalence; universalized cynicism; epistemic fog.
- **Operation:** When favorable comparison is no longer credible, make distinctions between better and worse appear unknowable or irrelevant: "everyone lies," "all sides are equally corrupt."
- **Integrity:** TI, II, RI.
- **Effect:** Moral fatigue suppresses discriminating judgment without rehabilitating the discredited actor on the facts.

LT-031 — Protection blackmail

- **Original term:** *Schutz-Erpressung*.
- **Operation:** Admit or normalize one's own harms while claiming that only submission to the harmful actor prevents an even worse enemy: "we may be harsh, but we are all that protects you."
- **Integrity:** II, RI, SI.

LT-032 — Reality-free escalation of invective

- **Original coined label:** *political Tourette syndrome*.
- **Project-developed mechanism name:** **projective-vandalism circuit.**
- **Operation:** Emit a continuous stream of increasingly grave accusations and taboo-laden insults with little evidential constraint, gaining affective force from the extremity of the vocabulary and from the strike against the symbolically stained target.
- **Originating sequence:** **Externalize the blemish → strike the blemish → enjoy the strike.**
- **Candidate operation sequence:**
 - disowned blemish
 - project it onto an opponent
 - mark the opponent with nuclear taboo vocabulary
 - create a morally attackable target surface
 - symbolically vandalize the target
 - receive audience resonance and possible surplus jouissance
 - repeat or escalate independently of reality
- **Functions:** Enemy construction, moral disinhibition, symbolic-face damage, audience synchronization, boundary signaling, and repetitive transgressive reward.
- **Distinctions:** Ordinary character assassination is primarily instrumental reputation destruction. Accusation in a Mirror pre-emptively attributes a particular intended or ongoing aggression to its prospective victim. Negative total projection supplies a generalized inventory of disowned badness. The projective-vandalism circuit identifies the repeated, affectively rewarded strike that can continue after factual or strategic utility has decayed.
- **Evidentiary boundary:** A hostile third-party label such as "Nazi" directly establishes that the accusation was made, not that the target instantiates the category. Nor does an unsupported or false accusation prove projection or confession by itself. The target classification and any projection hypothesis require independent evidence. See the [Attribution-Source Asymmetry](#).
- **Motivational status:** The surplus-jouissance interpretation is a proposed mechanism, not an observation licensed by vocabulary alone. Strategic signaling, anger, conformity, media incentives, and ordinary reputation warfare remain alternatives. The motivational account belongs to [Mythology Construction](#).
- **Integrity:** TI, RI, MI.

- **Naming caution:** The original label is metaphorical, not clinical, and risks stigmatizing a neurological condition. The descriptive heading above is preferred for the inventory.
- **Status:** Originating pattern and sequence, joined to a project-developed observable-operation model; not an established clinical or causal syndrome.

Compound-operation boundary — Materialized accusation and poison-and-accuse The proposed **poison-and-accuse** mechanism adds an actor-produced adverse event to Accusation in a Mirror and projective vandalism:

produce real harm H
 → attribute H to rival R
 → appear as witness, victim, or guardian
 → mobilize the audience against R

The observable communicative operation is **false localization of real harm**. It differs from inventing an event that never happened because independent inspection can confirm H while leaving the actor attribution false. The reality of the effect can then be misused as apparent support for the unsupported causal claim about R.

The full mechanism also includes sabotage, access, threat-detector capture, guardian-role appropriation, possible reward, and renewed operation, so its primary semantic home is *Mythology Construction, “Hidden-threat detection, explaining-away, and detector capture”*. This inventory records only the linguistic front end and its relation to LT-027, LT-029, LT-032, and LT-033.

The evidential order must remain:

real harm established
 ≠ source established
 ≠ false localization established
 ≠ accuser caused the harm
 ≠ resentment, reward, coordination, or death-drive established

Each stronger attribution requires its own evidence. An accurate warning about real harm, ordinary error about its source, or an independently supported causal accusation defeats the specific false-localization finding.

LT-033 — Script-forming threat preactivation

- **Original term:** *skriptbildende Voraktivierung*.
- **Operation:** Repeatedly narrate the opponent as an imminent aggressor so a later ambiguous event is automatically recognized through the prepared script: their act is attack; ours is defense.
- **Integrity:** TI, II, RI.
- **Status:** Primarily a downstream cognitive and social effect of repeated AiM, but retained because it explains why the linguistic operation matters over time.
- **Terminological boundary:** *Script* here means a preactivated interpretive sequence for classifying a later event. It is narrower than the **situated-cultural-script** construct, which joins a general cultural weave to distributed roles, routines, interfaces, improvisation, and practical support.

LT-038 — DARVO

- **Expansion:** Deny, Attack, and Reverse Victim and Offender.
- **German description:** denial, counterattack, and *Täter-Opfer-Umkehr*.
- **Operation:** When confronted with alleged wrongdoing, deny the conduct, attack the accuser or their credibility, and recast the accused party as the real victim and the confronting party as the offender.
- **Integrity:** TI, RI, DI, LI.
- **Distinction from AiM:** AiM is commonly pre-emptive and prepares aggression as defense. DARVO is commonly reactive and protects an actor from accountability after confrontation.
- **Relation to moral inversion:** The final DARVO stage is a form of moral inversion or *Täter-Opfer-Umkehr*, but DARVO names the complete three-stage sequence.
- **Status:** Established term.

LT-039 — Moralized character accusation

- **Source term:** Michael Andrick's account of *Moralisierung* in *Im Moralegefängnis: Spaltung verstehen und überwinden*.
- **Operation:** Move the focus from the disputed issue to the other person's character and the dialogue mode from inquiry to accusation. Reinterpret a statement, omission, association, missing conformity signal, imposed marker, or attributed target label as a revealing disclosure of character, then use that accusation to attack the person's standing or eligibility to participate.
- **Integrity:** RI, DI, LI.
- **Status:** Borrowed from Andrick and operationalized for this inventory; the culture-mechanical field extension is project-developed.
- **Related but distinct:** psychologizing Bulverism, redirection, covert dialogue-type switch, defamatory moral marking, and legitimate evidence-based judgment of conduct.
- **Systemic extension:** The complete signal-character accusation-exclusion-enforcement mechanism and Andrick's category of discursive violence are developed in *Culture Mechanics*; they are not reduced here to a linguistic trick.

LT-040 — Cue-function substitution (*Wie-Was manipulation*)

- **Source term:** Dushan Wegner's *Wie-Was-Manipulation in Relevante Strukturen* (2019).
- **Aliases:** recognition-cue substitution; cue-function mismatch; moral camouflage.
- **Operation:** Supply the learned perceptible cues by which an audience recognizes a valued category while the underlying operation, structure, or consequences that make the category applicable are absent, materially weaker, or opposed. The *Wie* is the recognition route; the *Was* is what the category is meant to identify.
- **Integrity:** MI, II, RI; sometimes SI.
- **Examples of the general form:** visible moral vocabulary without the corresponding conduct; credentials or institutional form without the claimed function; an orderly portal, taxonomy, dashboard, case number, database, or professional report whose administrative finish is taken as proof that inputs were authenticated or cases verified; symbolic compliance that substitutes for the result the symbol is supposed to indicate; camouflage or decoys that elicit a learned recognition response.
- **Diagnostic:** Specify the claimed category and its constitutive function, list the cues that activated recognition, inspect actual operation and consequences, and observe what happens when cue and function are compared openly.
- **Boundary:** Every practical category relies on fallible cues and proxies. Cue-function mismatch can arise through error, changed conditions, Goodhart-like drift, or an obsolete classification rule. Manipulation is a stronger inference requiring evidence such as strategic production of the cue, recurrent asymmetry, concealment of function, or resistance to consequence-based correction.
- **Status:** Wegner's distinction is retained in his language and operationalized here as a cross-domain diagnostic. It overlaps benevolent-language camouflage, ideological symbols, paramorality, and qualified-concept inversion without being reducible to any one of them.
- **Reporting-loop relation:** The administrative-form subtype can reinforce the *moralized observation-to-mandate loop*, but professional appearance alone establishes neither invalid data nor manipulation.

LT-041 — Doctrinal causal omission

- **Aliases:** semantic-wrapper / operational-payload concealment; undisclosed implementation; CPU-bigOther split address.
- **Operation:** Present an attractive explicit doctrine to reflective cognition while withholding a material affective, social, or institutional mechanism on which the doctrine's constructor or operator relies to produce its foreseeable practical effect. The hearer is invited to assent to the semantic wrapper without being given the bigOther-facing or institutional payload needed to evaluate the actual programme.
- **Integrity:** II, SI, MI, LI; sometimes TI.
- **Diagnostic:** State the public principles, reconstruct the expected recipient classifications and emotions, identify the implementing offices, sanctions, dependencies, and authority relations, then compare those layers with plans, training, audience segmentation, private predictions, and observed descendants. Ask whether disclosure would predictably change reasonable assent.
- **Responsibility gradient:** intentional concealed construction → knowing omission → reckless omission → negligent blindness → unforeseeable emergence.
- **Offspring-responsibility routing:** A related causal-story operation can leave the material sequence intact while moving programme-amplified harm from purpose or policy into mistake, impersonal mechanism, accident, nature, or an enemy. The audit asks whether the programme created, amplified, prolonged, scaled, or prevented

correction of the consequence before accepting the new grammatical subject. This is not proof of intentional design and does not replace quantitative causal decomposition.

- **Boundary:** No finite doctrine can state every causal consequence, and social effects often emerge without a designer. A wrapper–payload mismatch establishes a question, not a lie. The stronger verdict **doctrinal lying by omission** requires evidence of knowledge or sufficiently culpable foreseeability, materiality, non-disclosure, and reliance on the omitted mechanism.
- **Related but distinct:** LT-002 concerns selective concealment generally; LT-013 camouflages control in benevolent language; LT-014 sends coded meanings to different audiences; LT-040 substitutes recognition cues for function. LT-041 specifically conceals the causal implementation that joins a public doctrine to its expected cultural and institutional outcome.
- **Primary semantic home:** *Mythology Construction*, “*Doctrinal progeny, generative spirit, and responsibility*”.
- **Status:** Project-developed communicative operation extracted from the doctrinal-progeny and concealed-causal-design analysis.

E. Agenda, representation, and policy coupling

LT-034 — Pretext trap of the harmful fix

- **Original term:** *Vorwandfalle der Schadtlösung*.
- **Operation:** Use a real, exaggerated, selected, or apparently evidenced problem as the pretext for a preselected measure presented as its solution even though the measure does not address the demonstrated cause and may foreseeably preserve or worsen the problem. A true event can be the bait without establishing frequency, priority, or remedy fit.
- **Component operations:** Problem surfing; capture of scarce attention; a causal story serving as a pretextual bridge; argumentative coupling; possible report-to-reality or salience laundering; and concealment of the ineffective, misdirected, harmful, or placebo character of the remedy.
- **Recursive subtype:** The measure enlarges observation, intake, classification, or enforcement; the enlarged apparatus produces more recorded instances; and the new records are presented as proof that the original problem and measure were necessary. This is not self-disproof, but it requires observation intensity to be separated from underlying incidence.
- **Diagnostic:** Establish the problem independently, compare its magnitude and priority with displaced alternatives, reconstruct the remedy’s causal target, test narrower means and predicted outcomes, and ask whether the same capability was selected before or persists after the offered rationale. The stronger pretext claim requires chronology and actor-specific evidence; bad fit alone may be error, path dependence, mixed purpose, or institutional inertia.
- **Related mechanisms:** *Report-to-reality laundering and endogenous observation*, *the moralized observation-to-mandate loop*, and *control-first moral-wrapper selection*.
- **Sparse worked application:** The *Fernandes–HateAid–Hubig–ARD episode* supplies the reconstructable chronology, case-load discontinuity, broader-remedy comparison, correction test, and rival explanations needed to move beyond simple bad-fit allegation.
- **Integrity:** II, RI, TI, LI.
- **Status:** User-selected term.

LT-035 — Ventriloquism of constituencies

- **Aliases:** self-appointed representation; constructed-interest speech; speaking for “the people.”
- **Operation:** Construct a group’s interests and speak authoritatively in its name without authorization, internal plurality, or a route by which members can contradict the attributed voice.
- **Integrity:** XI, SI, DI.

LT-036 — Motte-and-bailey amplitude shift

- **Aliases:** mobilizing maximalism / scrutinized minimalism.
- **Operation:** Use a sweeping structural claim when mobilizing support, then retreat under criticism to a narrow technical claim; after scrutiny passes, return to the expansive implication.
- **Integrity:** TI, MI, DI.
- **Diagnostic:** Require one stable statement of the claim, its scope, and its proposed consequences across audiences.

LT-037 — Context and source manipulation

- **Aliases:** false context; imposter content; manipulated content; information laundering.
- **Operation:** Preserve or fabricate content while falsifying who produced it, where it appeared, when it applied, or what evidential standing it has. Apparent provenance substitutes for argument.
- **Integrity:** XI, TI.

4. Important boundaries

Honest error is not insincerity

A person can sincerely state a false belief, and can insincerely repeat a proposition that happens to be true. Sincerity and reality-tracking are distinct dimensions. The first constitutional step is to make it safe and normal for people to say what they actually think; only then can open disagreement test how well those beliefs track reality.

Semantic disagreement is not necessarily manipulation

Some disputes are genuinely verbal: participants attach different meanings to the same word. Clarifying definitions can dissolve confusion without establishing deceit. Shared definition repair is then the remedy, whereas covertly changing a definition while retaining its emotional force is LT-008.

At society scale, persistent divergence can contribute to **intergroup semantic decoupling** and eventually **cultural interoperability breakdown (Babelization)** even when no speaker is manipulating anyone. That is a systemic condition, not a linguistic trick. Shared definition repair, trusted translation, and legitimate common procedures can increase the effective thickness or span of lifted solidarity without requiring identical first-order meanings. [Mythology Construction](#), "[Cultural interoperability and its breakdown \(Babelization\)](#)" defines that larger condition and its anti-Babel floor.

Framing and conceptual engineering are not inherently dishonest

All finite descriptions select aspects of reality, and communities sometimes need better concepts. Manipulation begins when consequential selection or revision is hidden, rival descriptions are excluded from consideration, or the revised concept is represented as the word's uncontested natural meaning.

A recognition cue is not automatically a counterfeit

Language, credentials, symbols, institutional forms, and behavioural markers are often indispensable evidence of an otherwise difficult-to-observe function. LT-040 does not license the inference that every proxy is fraudulent. Its target is the inspectable mismatch between cue and function and, when manipulation is alleged, the further evidence that the mismatch was strategically produced, concealed, or immunized against correction.

Open-textured judgment is not automatically pseudo-measurement

Many legitimate decisions cannot be reduced to one number. Law, medicine, engineering, ecology, and ordinary practical judgment use qualitative standards, professional interpretation, and revisable boundary judgments. LT-043 does not require false precision or prohibit such judgment. It asks whether an apparently assessed predicate has an inspectable operational basis, exposes the human choice within it, and remains answerable to evidence, comparable cases, reasons, affected persons, review, and appeal. The absence of numbers is not the failure; the performance of measurement-authority without an operationally contestable judgment is.

The legal analogue likewise requires a strict separation:

vague or open-textured legal language
≠ surrogate rule-making or judicial activism
≠ adjudication serving the interpreter's group interest

Open texture can be unavoidable and can transparently delegate bounded judgment. It becomes an interpreter-custody affordance when the prospective rule leaves an operative classification, exception, or conflict rule unresolved. Surrogate rule-making is the further institutional operation in which a judge, regulator, commission, or administrator effectively supplies or varies that rule beyond its constituted jurisdiction. Group-interest adjudication is a still

further motive, beneficiary, or capture attribution requiring independent evidence. The [Sowell legal-surrogate branch](#) owns the complete sequence, comparative correction audit, and boundaries.

This is not necessarily LT-043. It becomes pseudo-metric predication only where measurement-like or threshold language presents a contestable classification as though an operational assessment had already delivered it. Otherwise the appropriate diagnosis may be ordinary legal interpretation, disclosed delegation, tacit criterion custody, authorization without specification, or case-level interpreter custody.

An omitted mechanism is not automatically a lie

Complex doctrines cannot enumerate every psychological, institutional, and historical condition of implementation. LT-041 requires a material gap between the offered reason for assent and an operational mechanism on which the constructor relies. Intentional or knowing concealment, private causal prediction, audience engineering, repeated adverse offspring, and refusal to disclose after the mechanism becomes visible strengthen the diagnosis. Mere hindsight does not.

A fallacy is not automatically a lie

Bad reasoning can arise from haste, ignorance, motivated cognition, or honest confusion. A fallacy therefore becomes a sophism only when its plausibility is used to conceal or exploit the defect in the argument. This inventory classifies communicative operations, not the speaker's inaccessible inner intent. Evidence of a pattern, asymmetrical application, strategic retreat, resistance to correction, or concealed dialogue purpose strengthens an inference of sophisticated or otherwise instrumental use.

Effects are not always tricks

Symbol displacement, pluralistic ignorance, moral fatigue, and script preactivation can emerge through distributed repetition without a central designer. They belong here where they explain how repeated speech acts become a culture mechanism, but they should not be mistaken for proof of an individual plot.

5. Relation to the epistemic constitution

This inventory is not primarily a blacklist of forbidden expressions. In a reality-anchored, truth-seeking epistemic constitution it supplies a common vocabulary—a yardstick installed in the social *big Other*—for noticing when communication departs from truth-seeking. The [introductory epistemic architecture](#) fixes the types, conditional sequence, and attribution boundaries. This section develops the deeper cross-theory interfaces and positive counterpart without redefining the architecture owned by *Epistemic Constitution*.

The entries identify local operations; [Epistemic Agency under Mechanical Solidarity](#), “[Audience-modelled reconstruction and decompression](#)” supplies a cross-cutting model of how several such operations can be combined against an anticipated recipient so that the recipient reconstructs a targeted factual, causal, moral, or authorization model.

Several operations can also be assembled into [un-reason](#): reasoning continues, but semantic distinctions, evidential burdens, exceptions, and replies to criticism are recursively arranged to keep a protected account from losing. Un-reason is not another LT entry. It is a wider inferential and institutional mechanism that sophistry, burden reversal, immunization, framing, or dialogue corruption may help implement. One fallacy, contested definition, or linguistic trick does not establish it.

The same local operations can supply the wording of an [auxiliary-un-reality explaining-away cascade](#). Selective framing can choose U1; psychologizing Bulverism can disqualify the observer; burden reversal can protect U1 from testing; scapegoating, accusation in a mirror, or moral inversion can assign adverse agency; and script-forming threat preactivation can make U1 immediately recognizable. These are possible linguistic components, not a new LT entry and not proof of the wider cascade. Legitimate alternative causal explanation remains outside the diagnosis when it is independently supported, reciprocally tested, and permitted to lose.

The inventory also keeps Orwell's two neighbouring mechanisms distinct. [Newspeak-style vocabulary restriction](#) changes the available symbolic repertoire. [Doublethink](#) allows incompatible beliefs to coexist, remain compartmentalized, or switch with authority without their contradiction correcting the account. The former is a linguistic operation; the latter is a cognitive and potentially institutional mechanism. Either can support un-reason or systemic lying, but neither entails the other and neither is established by one euphemism or contradiction.

Pragma-dialectics as prior work toward communicative truthfulness

Frans H. van Eemeren and Rob Grootendorst's *A Systematic Theory of Argumentation: The Pragma-Dialectical Approach* is established prior work for the positive communicative side of the inventory. [Chapter 3, "A model of a critical discussion," pp. 42–68](#), sets out the ideal discussion through confrontation, opening, argumentation, and conclusion. [Chapter 6, "Rules for a critical discussion," pp. 123–157](#), supplies the procedural rules behind freedom to advance and question standpoints, disclosed burdens, relevant defence, faithful representation, and explicit closure. These provide counter-standards to many entries here.

The borrowing remains partial. *Epistemic Constitution* owns the [complete positive interface](#) that joins pragma-dialectically reasonable discussion to independent reality-answerability and communicative integrity. This inventory applies that interface to communicative operations and preserves the controlling distinction:

Pragma-dialectics supplies internal procedural reasonableness; Culture Mechanics adds external answerability to evidence and reality.

A procedurally fair discussion can reach a false conclusion. A systemic-lying order can also preserve the ceremony of critical discussion while controlling admissibility, opponent selection, burdens, consequences, and the conditions under which the authorized account may lose. One rule breach does not by itself establish a trick, instrumental untruthfulness, un-reason, un-reality, or systemic lying; perfect procedural compliance does not establish correspondence with reality.

Habermas's communicative-action versus strategic-action distinction remains the neighbouring bridge for the orientation contrast between communicative integrity and instrumental untruthfulness. Pragma-dialectics contributes the more explicit procedural spine; the present project adds reality-correction, cultural installation, and constitutional scale.

Pragma-dialectics asks whether disagreement was conducted reasonably. Reality-answerability asks whether reality is still permitted to overturn its result.

The corresponding positive virtues are:

1. State what one actually believes and distinguish belief from knowledge.
2. Check simple factual claims before amplifying them.
3. Present material counterevidence, trade-offs, and uncertainty.
4. Keep meanings explicit, shared, and corrigible.
5. Represent an opponent's actual strongest position.
6. Answer the proposition before discussing the speaker.
7. Apply comparable evidential burdens to allies and opponents.
8. Keep the kind and rules of the dialogue visible.
9. Preserve provenance and context.
10. Permit correction without making honest concession socially ruinous.
11. Test identity-bearing and moral recognition cues against actual function and consequences.
12. Compare CPU-facing principles with the affective and institutional mechanisms expected to implement them.
13. Decompress apparently measured predicates into their object, rule, evidence, threshold or boundary, trade-offs, defeaters, and appeal route.
14. When a center-periphery reversal is proposed, disclose the selection and standing rule, preserve justified functions, and subject the successor center to the same evidential, jurisdictional, and person-protecting constraints.
15. When a new causal account explains adverse evidence away, require independent support, reciprocal testing, predictive exposure, and a declared condition under which that account would lose.
16. Make the evidential hierarchy visible: state the principal finding, decisive support, necessary qualifications, and bounded conclusion before routing secondary context and remote possibilities into their proportionate place.

The inventory's function is thus constitutional and formative: it helps individuals recognize and resist small acts of public untruthfulness, while their repeated resistance changes the public norm that subsequently forms other individuals.

6. Provenance and limitations

Private project-development conversations underlie many entries but are not part of this publication. Where no public source is cited, an LT label and its definition are project formulations, not claims that an external work uses

the same term or independently verifies the mechanism.

This version was produced through structured review of private project source material, vocabulary expansion, contextual reading, synonym normalization, and boundary auditing. Source filenames, links, conversation identifiers, and internal prompt logs are intentionally withheld from this publication.

LT-039, LT-040, and LT-041 are explicit exceptions to that private discovery route. LT-039 was added from Michael Andrick's book material and linked directly to the underlying publication. LT-040 was added from Dushan Wegner's *Relevante Strukturen* (2019, ISBN 978-3-7394-0563-6), whose *Wie-Was* distinction is retained while the operational test and boundary are project-developed. LT-041 was developed in this project from the doctrinal-progeny analysis. Its originating contribution supplied the CPU-facing and bigOther-facing contrast; the inventory supplies the normalized operation, responsibility gradient, and evidential boundary.

This is a high-recall working inventory, not a claim of semantic exhaustiveness. The reviewed source collection is large, the same mechanism may have been discussed without any of the recovered names, and several private sources contain long embedded source texts. Future revisions should add newly found mechanisms only after checking whether they are genuinely distinct operations or aliases, combinations, effects, and institutional deployments of types already recorded here.

The labels *Reversive Blockade* and *Zufallsmehrheiten* were supplied by the project author but were not found verbatim in the reviewed source corpus during this pass. They are deliberately retained with provisional provenance rather than silently attributed to a published source.